

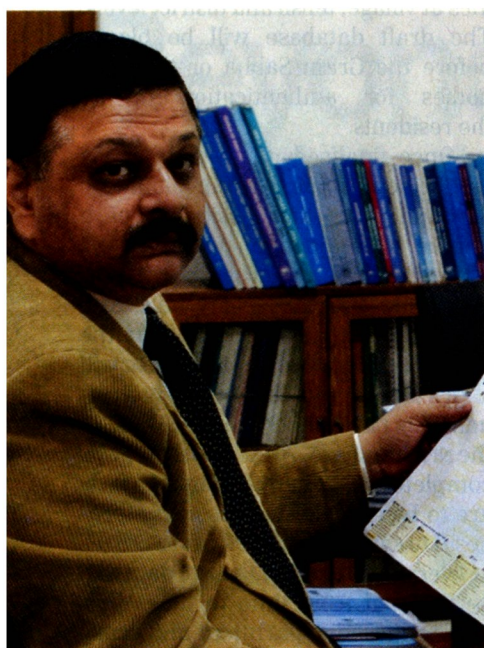
checking identity frauds.

Though Nandan Nilekani, chairperson of the UIDAI, has claimed that he would be able to issue the first unique number within 2010, RGI officials say that it may take more time. As the filled-up forms will be in many languages, parts of the work will be needed to be done manually because the software may not recognise several languages, making data processing lengthy.

After completion of the house listing and housing census and data collection for the NPR, the second part of

the Union Government to hold a caste-based census. Also, while hearing the cases against reservation for the OBCs in the IITs and IIMs, the Government said in the Supreme Court in 2007 that there was no data on the OBCs. Says Chandramouli, "This is up to the Government to decide. We have to finalise the forms for second phase of the census soon." As of now, the Government has made preparations for the census without including the caste column. The meeting of the technical advisory committee to

To avoid the duplication and omission, the RGI has digitised maps of each and every village of the country and the Map Division of the RGI is printing these. Says A.P. Singh, deputy director-general, Map Division, "We will print over 6.50 lakh maps before the census to make the job of our enumerators easy." Every district will have separate forms for the census and for the NPR as well. For smooth conduct of Census 2011, the RGI has recruited over 1,200 officers and staff as statistical cadre. The GIS mapping has been done

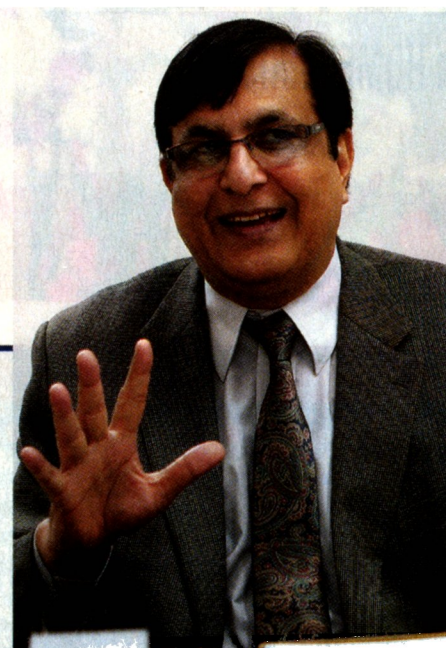


Our job would be complicated. We will knock on every door of the 24 crore households in India and count every head within a given time limit."

C. CHANDRAMOULI, Registrar General & Census Commissioner

This census is going to reveal the complete picture of the socio-economic conditions and quality of life of the people of India."

R.C SETHI, Additional Registrar General



Photographs by SUBIR HALDER/www.indiatodayimages.com

the census will be initiated and person to person counting will be done in February next year and will be completed by March 5. Previously, it took around five years to come out with census reports and detailed analysis. But census officials say that this time they will come out with all such reports and their analysis by the end of 2013.

While pre-Independence censuses gathered caste data as well, the post-Independence reports have so far gathered information only about the SC/ST population. Now the Government of West Bengal and some social organisations have requested

approve the forms for the second phase of the census is scheduled to be held next month.

There will be 64 crore forms in 16 languages for two parts of the census and these will be printed at 15 locations in the country. For dissemination of these forms and other materials, the services of India Post are being utilised for the first time. These materials will go directly from the press to 17,500 officers in charge. The size of the entire exercise can be gauged from the fact that over 21 lakh enumerators and four lakh supervisors are engaged at the grassroots level. The number of these enumerators is higher than the population of 82 countries in the world.

for 33 capital cities of the country.

The first census in India was conducted in 1872. Politicians often try to interpret the census data for political gains, but as Chandramouli says, "Our job is only to provide credible data, we are not here to give anybody anything or to take anything from anybody." Chidambaram understands it when he says, "There had been occasions when state Governments came up with the plea that the census had not been conducted properly in their states. The officers, who conduct the census and certify the exercise, are their own officials." Hopefully, the 15th census will bring an end to these claims and counter-claims. ■